

```
a:visited {  
color:#999;  
}  
a:hover {  
color:#333;  
}  
a:active {  
color:#000;  
}
```

Notice that the first letter of each pseudo class is in bold, giving us the letters L V H A. This order is very important if you wish for the links to behave properly, and can be remembered as LoVe HAte. For example, if you were to place the `a:hover` selector above the `a:visited` selector (giving you the order L H V A), you would have a situation where the `a:hover` declaration would have no effect upon the visited state because of the way the cascade works. The text would remain light gray even on hover, going against expected behaviour. There may be cases where such an approach is required, but this will be rare and is probably best avoided.

Now that you understand the basics of CSS link control and can affect any of the four core link states, it is worth considering some other very useful properties designed specifically for links, and some more universal properties that can also be applied.

7.5 Basic CSS rules for links

7.5.1 text-decoration

So far, you may have noticed that all links, regardless of state, are underlined with a colour matching the link text. This is a default style that is very easily removed using the `text-decoration` property. Possible values are `none`, `underline` (the default value), `overline`, `line-through`, and `blink`. These values are very self-explanatory, but again be very aware of how usable and intuitive your links are when custom styles are used. The `text-decoration` property can be applied to any of the four link states, as in this example for the `:hover` pseudo class:

```
a:hover {  
color:#333;  
text-decoration:none;  
}
```